

Emilio Barkett

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| EDUCATION         | <div><div>Columbia University2024 – 2025</div><div>M.A. in Media Studies &amp; Sociology<br/>Research Advisors: Diane Vaughan, James Chu   GPA 3.97/4.00<br/>Thesis: <i>Status Hierarchies in Language Models</i></div><div>Brigham Young University–Hawaii2022 – 2024</div><div>B.A. in Communication; Minor in Political Science<br/>Research Advisor: Mason Allred   GPA 3.81/4.00</div></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| AREAS OF INTEREST | Human-AI Interaction; Language Model Behavior; Trust & Deception; Well-Being; Social Media                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| BOOK              | <div>[1] Outstanding Stories from Kiribati.<br/><b>Emilio Barkett</b><br/><i>Barnes and Noble Press</i>, 2022. <a href="#">[link]</a></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| PUBLICATIONS      | <div><div>[3] Getting out of the Big-Muddy: Escalation of Commitment in LLMs.<br/><b>Emilio Barkett</b>, Olivia Long, Paul Kröger<br/><i>AAAI</i>, 2026. <a href="#">[under review]</a> <a href="#">[arXiv]</a>.</div><div>[2] Don't Change My View: Ideological Bias Auditing in Large Language Models.<br/>Paul Kröger, <b>Emilio Barkett</b><br/><i>AAAI</i>, 2026. <a href="#">[under review]</a> <a href="#">[arXiv]</a>.</div><div>[1] Reasoning Isn't Enough: Examining Truth-Bias and Sycophancy in LLMs.<br/><b>Emilio Barkett</b>, Olivia Long, Madhavendra Thakur<br/><i>ICML</i>, 2025. <a href="#">[arXiv]</a>.</div></div>                                                                                                                                                                         |
| WORKS IN PROGRESS | <div><div>[6] Status Hierarchies in Language Models.<br/><b>Emilio Barkett</b><br/><i>Working Paper / Master's Thesis</i>.</div><div>[5] Truthfulness Across Languages in LLMs.<br/><b>Emilio Barkett</b>, Paul Kröger, Madhavendra Thakur<br/><i>Working Paper</i>.</div><div>[4] Truth Default Theory in LLMs.<br/><b>Emilio Barkett</b>, Paul Kröger, Olivia Long, Anwen Hao<br/><i>Working Paper</i>.</div><div>[3] Normalization of Deviance in AI Development.<br/><b>Emilio Barkett</b>, Nick Meyer<br/><i>Working Paper</i>.</div><div>[2] Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development.<br/><b>Emilio Barkett</b><br/><i>Working Paper</i>.</div><div>[1] Evaluating AI Persuasion Across Socioeconomic Status.<br/><b>Emilio Barkett</b>, Robin Hart, Zeming Lu<br/><i>Working Paper</i>.</div></div> |
| WORK EXPERIENCE   | <div><div>Columbia Business SchoolNew York, NY<br/><i>Research Intern</i><br/>Research Advisor: Alan ZhangJune 2025 – Present</div></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

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|                         | <b>Columbia AI Alignment Club</b><br><i>Principal Investigator / Policy Facilitator</i><br>Research Advisor: Yau-Meng Wong                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | New York, NY<br>Jan 2025 – Present                            |
|                         | <b>Columbia University</b><br><i>Research Assistant</i><br>Research Advisor: James Chu                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | New York, NY<br>Jan 2025 – Present                            |
|                         | <b>Brigham Young University–Hawaii</b><br><i>UX Research Associate / Data Scientist</i><br>Research Advisors: Curtis Lefrandt, Scott Stiles                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Oahu, HI<br>April 2022 – June 2024                            |
| AWARDS &<br>FELLOWSHIPS | Claude Campus Ambassador, Anthropic.<br>AI Policy Fellowship, Columbia AI Alignment Club.<br>Service Scholarship, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, \$1,500.<br>Dean’s List Scholarship, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, \$500.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | August 2025 – Present<br>Jan 2025 – June 2025<br>2022<br>2022 |
| PRESENTATIONS           | <b>Conferences</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• AAAI 2026, Singapore, January 2026. <i>Getting out of the Big Muddy: Escalation of Commitment in LLMs</i> [Submitted]</li> <li>• AAAI 2026, Singapore, January 2026. <i>Don’t Change My View: Ideological Bias Auditing in Large Language Models</i> [Submitted]</li> <li>• Beyond Our Screens: Reimagining Critical Media Literacy Symposium, University of Notre Dame, August 2025. <i>Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development</i></li> <li>• ICML 2025 Workshop, Vancouver, Canada, July 2025. <i>Reasoning Isn’t Enough: Examining Truth-Bias and Sycophancy in LLMs</i></li> <li>• Cultural Studies Association 2025 Conference, California Institute of the Arts, May 2025. <i>Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development</i></li> <li>• Data Science Day, Columbia University, April 2025. <i>Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development</i></li> <li>• AI Summit, Columbia University, March 2025. <i>Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development</i></li> <li>• Artifacts of Control, Lincoln Center for the Performing Arts, Dec 2024. <i>Surveillance on University Campuses</i></li> <li>• Undergraduate Research Conference, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, Dec 2024. <i>Media and War: A Genealogy of the Alternate Narrative</i></li> </ul> |                                                               |
| ACADEMIC<br>SERVICE     | <b>Reviewer</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Conferences: NeurIPS (2025)</li> <li>• Workshops: Models of Human Feedback for AI Alignment (ICML 2025), Socially Responsible Language Modelling Research (COLM 2025), AI for Social Impact (AAAI 2026)</li> </ul> <b>Academic Groups</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Media in the Digital Age Interest Group, Allan Turing Institute. Oct 2024 – Present</li> <li>• Science, Knowledge, and Technology Workshop, Columbia University. Aug 2024 – Present</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                               |
| RESEARCH<br>METHODS     | <b>Quantitative Research:</b><br>Survey design, regression analysis, text analysis, web prototyping, computational social science, machine learning, natural language processing<br><br><b>Qualitative Research:</b><br>Ethnographic field research, interviews, focus groups, content analysis, speculative methods, think-aloud protocol, usability testing                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                               |
| COMPUTER &<br>CODE      | Python (pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib), R, SPSS, Qualtrics, NVivo, L <sup>A</sup> T <sub>E</sub> X                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                               |
| LANGUAGES               | English (native), Gilbertese (advanced), American Sign Language (basic)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                               |